

ChE 427 (Engineering and Entrepreneurship)
Department of Chemical Engineering
University of Illinois Chicago
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Quiz 2
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The following companies managed to leverage their intellectual portfolio (i.e. licenses, patents, partnerships) to build a successful business model. Discuss briefly each case and highlight their path to success:

1) Pfizer:

Pfizer sells a product. They are a well-known medication and vaccination company that develops and manufactures their products. They have merged with several other companies to gain proprietary information and continue to develop. They buy other companies, and hold proprietary information to their advantage, they have medication which is high risk high reward and vaccinations which are a more stable form of income. They have been a long-standing company, were early in the game, and have maintained being a large player within the healthcare space.

They sell a physical product, they have patents, and they benefit from partnering with various hospitals and buying out other companies.

2) Spotify:

Spotify sells a subscription for their marketing strategy. Based on my familiarity with them, they would have to have multiple relationships with different musical artists, and record labels in order to sell their product. They are licensed to use the product they are selling. They also make an income from their "free" product by generating revenue off of advertisements. They partner with other companies, and use the user information to target their ads. The ability to offer "free" services is a large advantage over their competitors, and they make a lot of revenue off of targeted ads. They also do not pay the artists well, so they gain more profit.

3) Uber:

Uber sells a service, offers subscription options, and has expanded their services in multiple ways (from Uber to UberEats). They became successful because it allowed people to easily make money on the side (from driving), and kept people reputable based on ratings. It also has a lot of ease from the customer stand point, from booking a ride (immediately or scheduled, for you or your friend/family), to paying, to no longer having to go out to eat out. Keeping their services reputable, and relying on people looking to easily make a decent amount of money on the side, they have become a giant within this industry.